known then that to get to Tsangle, the route would have to be via Tsangdhar and though, on the map, it looked reasonably close it would take the better part of fourteen hours to get there. Secondly, and far more importantly, the Intelligence Bureau's information that there were already more than two Chinese regiments—almost six times the projected force levels—just behind the rear slopes of Thagla, between Tsona Dzong and Le, had not been communicated to either Dalvi or Prasad. For that matter, it is doubtful if the DMO had passed on this important bit of information to either Eastern Command or XXXIII Corps. The withholding of this crucial bit of information by both Mullik, the Intelligence Bureau chief, and by Palit, the DMO, on the assumption that the Chinese would not use this force to actually attack, has to be one of the most bizarre acts of omission in the entire tragedy.

On 26 September, Umrao Singh arrived at Lumpu. He discussed the appreciation with his two subordinate commanders and instructed them to make certain changes. First, he laid additional emphasis on artillery support and, second, he asked Dalvi and Prasad to remove the suggested timeline. The modifications having been made, the appreciation was sent off to Corps HQ who in turn marked it to Eastern Command.

Umrao Singh was in no hurry to leave and spent the next two days studying the ground situation. He also had plenty of time to see for himself the condition of both 2 Rajput and 1/9 GR who by then had or were in the process of reaching Lumpu. After the government's 22 September directive, Bogey Sen had revised his attack plans and had decided to deploy the entire brigade against the Chinese and secure the Thagla feature by the first week of October. Purely from a logistical point of view, it was soon obvious to Umrao Singh that there was absolutely no way that 7 Brigade could be deployed in the Nam Ka Chu Valley in the immediate future and move up to the Thagla ridgeline in the face of Chinese resistance. Despite the massive logistics effort, it was obvious that even if all the airdrops were successfully retrieved and porters and mules assembled to ferry the loads to the Nam Ka Chu Valley, there would barely be enough ammunition to sustain 7 Brigade for one hour's fighting if the attack was to be launched even at the end of October 1962.

Before leaving Lumpu on 28 September, Umrao Singh gave explicit orders that there would be no further concentration of troops ahead of Lumpu until the bare minimum of ammunition and stocks had been